



Project Marzipan by Apple

Apple is serious about Project Marzipan that will allow devs to create single app for iPhone, iPad, and Mac devices. <https://dgit.in/mar19-87>



Qualcomm's mesh Wi-Fi dev-kit

Qualcomm's first development kit for mesh Wi-Fi that also integrates Amazon Alexa Voice Service (AVS). <https://dgit.in/mar19-88>

Samsung 970 EVO Plus NVMe M.2 SSD 250 GB

The first SSD with 96-layer NAND



Price
₹6,479

Samsung provided the 250 GB SKU which is the lowest SKU and what would be most commonly sought in the market. Unfortunately, we believe that the 1TB SKU of the 970 EVO Plus would perform much better as is the case with all SSDs.

We see that the older Samsung 970 EVO ends up with much better performance in mixed workloads of randomised read and write runs. In sustained 4K workloads of short queues, the performance of the 970 Evo Plus doubles compared to the previous workload. However, the older 970 EVO 1 TB ends up being better with higher write speeds.

In sequential tests, we see the 970 EVO Plus has the highest read speeds among the competition but is at roughly half the write performance. The only other drive to share in its company is the 760p from Intel.

The Samsung 970 EVO Plus consumes a lot of power while active as is the case with most high performing drives. As for idle power consumption, the 970 EVO Plus is at a match with its predecessor, the 970 EVO.

Despite the obvious handicap, the 970 EVO Plus does match up to its predecessor in certain benchmarks, especially when read speeds are concerned. With regards to write speeds, we can't say for sure. At Rs.25/GB the Samsung 970 EVO Plus is a good mid-range SSD.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

MZ-V7S250 | FORM FACTOR: M.2 2280 | COST/GB: Rs. 25.92 | DIMENSIONS: 80 x 22 x 2.38 mm | CONTROLLER: Samsung Phoenix | Samsung 96-layer 3D NAND | WARRANTY: 5 years

CONTACT

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HP Notebook 15

For those only seeking good performance



Price
₹54,990

The HP Notebook 15 brings with it a 256GB PCIe solid-state drive. That seems to make all the difference on the otherwise banal laptop. It doesn't look impressive. The 15.6-inch non-touchscreen display features Full HD resolution and 220 nits of maximum brightness but lacks contrast. There's no dedicated graphics on board for the half a lakh rupees the HP Notebook 15 commands. The speakers on the HP Notebook 15 are best reserved for those tiny error dings you hear in Windows. The keyboard and mouse are also pretty average.

Even if it hurts a little, the truth about the HP Notebook 15 is that its performance really is the only thing that sets it apart from the crowd, and that comes courtesy of the 8th Gen Intel Core i5 chip and the speedy solid-state drive inside. The ample RAM definitely helps as well. The battery life is a decent five hours but could have been longer. Otherwise, there's nothing special about it. You'd find this sort of body construction and underwhelming display on a laptop that's even half its price. That said, if you think about it, performance is what usually matters most to the average laptop buyer. So, if you're that sort of buyer who can forgive a mainstream laptop for lacking a lot of things like USB Type-C, keyboard backlighting, and dedicated graphics but simply can't do without speedy performance, then the HP Notebook 15 is definitely for you.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: 15-da0077bx | PROCESSOR: Intel® Core™ i5-8250U | MEMORY: 8 GB DDR4-2400 SDRAM (1 x 8 GB) | HARD DRIVE: 1 TB 5400 rpm SATA | DISPLAY: 15.6" FHD WLED-backlit (1920 x 1080) | GRAPHICS: NVIDIA® GeForce® MX110 (2 GB GDDR5)

CONTACT

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